

history. Gamers are always the ones who will surprise people at a get together with their arcane knowledge of history or culture because they learnt it in a game. They know stuff about wars that were fought, famous generals, locations, names of important civilisations and structures, etc.

Because big budget games are usually well researched and go very in-depth into their relative subject matters, they are usually accurate. Of course we're not suggesting that you believe a game over your history book, but more often than not, the two will agree.

The surprise factor of this knowledge is often worth its weight in pure gold. There's nothing like showing up a snooty rich kid who pretends to be all cultured and knowledgeable at a party – especially if it's in front of a girl or guy you have the hots for... Or maybe we've just been watching too many silly flicks with bad scripts that are written specifically to make geeks like us feel good about ourselves.

7 TEAMWORK AND COOPERATION

Games like *World of Warcraft* and other MMORPGs require communication between a large number of people for successful raids. And games like *DotA*, *LoL* and *Counter Strike* need good communication between teams of five members in order to function as a team. It's not uncommon for gamers to make good friends over the internet these days. And thanks to the highly sociable environment that online games create, people who play online games are often found to be sociable in real life as well.

However, the most important aspect of multiplayer gaming is that it teaches us gamers patience, and the need to cooperate and work towards a common goal. Thanks to the increasing penetra-

tion of broadband internet in India, more and more people are starting to play multiplayer games, and as a result, more and more people are learning the valuable lesson of teamwork. As we've learnt from our online gaming sessions ourselves, a good team average players with great understanding and willingness to cooperate often beats a team of skilled individuals who all go at it alone. So what are you waiting for? If you're a multiplayer gamer, you better start updating your CV right away and adding in all the jargon we've thrown at you. Who knew playing *WoW* and *DOTA* would allow you to add skills to your biodata, right?

8 STRESS MANAGEMENT / LEARNING TO LOSE

If there's one thing gamers are really good at, it's keeping their cool. PC gamers especially are like Xen masters. No one knows how frustrating it can be to try and then fail, and then try again, and fail even more miserably, but never giving up, no matter how useless the goal seems, until at last you succeed. You just cannot be a gamer if you can't handle frustration and defeat. We gamers learn from our mistakes like no other, and we do it (mostly) without losing our cool. Add to that the fact that PC gamers have to put up with Windows bugs, dying hard drives, constant upgrade cycles and buggy drivers... As if the games weren't hard enough on their own, we have to deal with a bucketload of other problems. It's all worth it in the end though, because we always excel, we always overcome, we always win. PC Master Race ftw!

Oh we almost forgot. We're supposed to mention a game name: try *Keep Talking* and *Nobody Explodes* if you want to try a really stressful game.

9 RISK TAKING

Going with the previous point, you can't learn to take calculated risks unless you have both lost and won in life. That's pretty much the standard description of a gamer. Taking risks is part of games, and with the serious nature of a lot of games these days, there's often actual money or a large time investment involved. If you fail, you stand to lose upgrades, or stuff you've bought, or worked hard for... there's "real" loss involved these days, not cute "deaths" like



in the Super Mario days. All of this makes gamers more prepared for real life problems, especially in work environments.

10 ENTREPRENEURIAL ABILITY

Tycoon games have been around for some time now. Our first taste of it was *Zoo Tycoon*, and boy was that fun. At first it was just fun to put people in cages with gorillas (to soon?), and watch as they were terrorised, eventually we started playing the game to win. Then things got really serious – from ticket pricing to choosing the cost of snacks, managing the cost of the hired help and having to account for maintenance costs, pretty soon we were thinking long and hard about every financial decision.



However, it's not just business sense from tycoon games, there's also online RPGs for instance, which have little economies of their own, and you have to learn to master the rules of the game to succeed and gather resources. You learn about supply and demand, and how important it is to have what is in demand, etc. All of this adds up to gamers being really savvy money managers, and perhaps prepares them for the stock markets. Of course, all of the smarts we earn from games can't prevent us from splurging on something extravagant to enhance our gaming experience! We're only human after all!

